rather than ships due to the revolution in transport. Strong migration networks also led to a clustering of residential choices as over three-fourths of the Indian diaspora settled along the M1 and M6 highways connecting London, Leicester, Coventry, Birmingham, Manchester, Leeds and finally Bradford, where that famous all-Patel cricket match took place.

Assimilation in British society was never going to be easy, especially with the colonial baggage of prejudices on both sides. Cricket itself became a litmus test of loyalty. The Tebbit test, named after Lord Tebbit, proposed that Indians could be considered to have successfully assimilated into British society only if they rooted for England during cricket matches against India. With a few exceptions like Madras-born Nasser Hussain, former captain of the England cricket team, most people of Indian origin would flunk this test even today, even though they have integrated on various other counts such as language and civic and political participation. Tensions rose high not so much with the British as against the Pakistani diaspora with occasional conflicts. Inter-generational conflict also occurred, best reflected in phrases such as British-Born Confused Desis (BBCDs) and Fresh off the Boats (FOBs) that clearly demarcated two different identities. Significantly, Britain was also shaped considerably by the Indian influx, developing a taste for the cuisine served in Indian (and Bangladeshi) restaurants that popularized chicken tikka masala and nightclubs that played bhangra music.

In the past two decades, Indian immigration has increased through the student–work migration route and was increasingly drawn towards high-skilled jobs in the finance and IT sectors, as the low-skill sectors were swamped by migrants from the European Union, who had preferential access to labour markets. As a result, the Indian community now has a much more positive image, marked by tremendous entrepreneurial energy. Britain serves as a base for Lakshmi Mittal, steel tycoon and one of the richest magnates in the world, and numerous other Indian-origin business leaders. In 2010, one India-born businessman, Sanjiv Mehta, revived the East India Company by purchasing trademarks and assets associated with the firm that ceased to exist in 1874. The Company that had brought Britain